SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

Islamic Studies | The Pillars of Prayer (Arkan al-Salah)

Source basis: The supplied excerpts from Fathul Mu'een and their discussion of the structure and classification of the pillars of prayer. This is a newly prepared portfolio sample based on the supplied pages; it is not presented as a lesson previously taught.

Lesson overview

Intended learners	Senior secondary / advanced Islamic Studies learners; adapt terminology and depth to the actual class.
Duration	45 minutes
Prior learning	Learners know the basic sequence of salah and can identify its principal actions.
Learning outcomes	By the end, learners will be able to: (1) explain what is meant by the pillars of prayer; (2) classify examples into verbal, physical, and heart-related pillars as presented in the excerpt; (3) distinguish a pillar from an action that is not itself a pillar; and (4) explain why the sequence and performance of the pillars matter.

Key content

The excerpt discusses the pillars (arkan) as essential components of prayer and groups them in broad categories: intention (niyyah) as heart-related; prescribed recitations and utterances as verbal; and standing, bowing, rising, prostration, and sitting as physical actions. The teacher should follow the exact wording and classification of the assigned text and the school's adopted fiqh framework.

Learning sequence

1. Retrieval and entry question — 5 min

Ask learners to list actions and utterances in the prayer sequence. Invite them to consider: "Are all actions in prayer equal in status?"

2. Guided reading — 10 min

Read the supplied passage in short sections. Clarify the terms rukn, niyyah, qawli, fi'li, and tartib using the text's own definitions. Learners annotate the passage for each category.

3. Sorting task — 10 min

In pairs, sort teacher-prepared cards (e.g., intention, opening takbir, recitation of al-Fatiha, bowing, standing after bowing, prostration, sitting between prostrations, final tashahhud) into the categories indicated in the excerpt. Students must point to textual evidence for their choices.

4. Sequence and reasoning — 10 min

Give pairs a shuffled sequence of selected prayer components. Ask them to order the actions and explain why order matters. Discuss one intentionally misplaced card and ask learners to identify the problem.

5. Individual formative check — 7 min

Learners answer three prompts: define a pillar of prayer in their own words; classify two examples with reasons; and explain one difference between recognising a term and understanding its role in prayer.

6. Recap and exit slip — 3 min

Each learner writes one pillar they can now explain, one question that remains, and one line or idea from the passage that supports their answer.

Assessment evidence

Use the paired sorting and sequencing task to listen for conceptual reasoning, then review the individual exit slips. Look for accurate use of terminology, classification supported by the text, and a clear explanation rather than memorised labels alone. Re-teach categories that are confused by using examples from the supplied passage.

Differentiation and access

Provide a short glossary and visual sequence cards for learners who need language support. Offer sentence starters such as "I classified this as ___ because the passage says ___." Extend confident learners by asking them to compare two classifications using evidence from the assigned text rather than relying on memory alone.

Teacher reflection after delivery

Which terms were difficult to distinguish? Did learners justify classifications with textual evidence? Which misconception should be revisited in the next lesson?

Accuracy note: This plan is a teaching-design sample, not a religious ruling. Verify all examples, terminology, and classifications against the exact edition of Fathul Mu'een, its commentary being used, and the school's adopted fiqh framework before classroom use.